AI ADVISOR & FORWARD DEPLOYED ENGINEER · SENIOR IT TRANSFORMATION LEADER

# Filip Truyens



IT transformation leader with more than thirty years of experience in the private and public sectors. Today I advise organizations on AI. As a Forward Deployed Engineer (FDE), I also build together with the client. I do this under my own brand, Fender ICT · AI Advisory.

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| **33+** | **20** | **16** |
| years in IT, since April 1993 | employers and clients | certifications earned |

## Profile

I lead change in organizations that cannot afford mistakes: banks, insurers and government. I operate where technology, governance and risk meet. I have worked on projects in public cloud, in security, and today also in AI.

My background is program management. I translate strategic objectives into a multi-year roadmap, a budget and a team that knows what to do. Working as an FDE asks for more. I know the rules for security and privacy, and I speak the language of the IT department. I work out the business case and involve right from the start the people who will eventually use the solution.

Since late 2025 I have also been building solutions myself, with the help of AI. Preliminary work that used to take weeks now takes days. That leaves more time for consultation, eventually resulting in a better output.

## AI Advisory

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| **Advice** | **AI advice**<br>Together with management, I look at where AI fits, where it does not and what it may do. I also check how it stays within the rules for security, privacy and audit. |
| **Co-creation** | **Forward Deployed Engineer**<br>A Forward Deployed Engineer does not work from a distance, but on site at the client. I build until the solution works and teach the team to use it. |
| **Experience** | **More than an engineer**<br>A good Forward Deployed Engineer combines strategy, budget, IT and security, change management and software. I built up that combination over thirty years, in many sectors. |
| **Approach** | **Rules and numbers first**<br>I start with the rules. What may AI do, under the regulations and within what the IT department allows? Then I look at the numbers. What does a task cost today, and what does AI deliver? |

**First client**

**Puur Reizen**

For a travel agency, I set up a shared AI workspace in ChatGPT Business together with the team. They now work consistently with their own tone of voice, house style and house rules.

## What I built with AI

2025 – 2026

Working software, built by me with the help of AI.

2025 – present

Own project

### Personal AI operating system

My own AI working environment, which I built and use every day.

- A growing library of skills, a memory system and AI agents I configure myself, for research, software and documentation.
- Works with Claude Code and with Codex, with the same skills on both sides.

**Technology:** Claude Code, Codex, Python, JavaScript, Markdown

Oct 2026 – present

Puur Reizen

### Customer portal and back office for Puur Reizen

Brings customers, trips, documents and invoices together in one place for a travel agency.

- Customers request a trip, see their own trips and invoices, and upload their travel documents themselves.
- The agency follows every trip by status, raises deposit and balance invoices, and sees requests, revenue and upcoming departures in reports.
- Status changes are proposals that a staff member confirms. Staff sign in with their Microsoft account.
- The data stays with the agency, with an open API, exports and webhooks. An AI application gets read-only access by default.

**Technology:** TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Microsoft Entra ID, REST API

Jul 2026

Smals

### Resource Capacity Planner

One shared, live view of which teams are stretched and which are not.

- Sets operational load against project work for **some forty technical teams**. It works at three levels, from team lead and division head to the Office of the CTO.
- From data model to live dashboards, running in production on Google Cloud.
- Replaced a set of manually maintained spreadsheets that nobody fully trusted.

**Technology:** Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

Apr 2026

Smals

### Automated NIS-2 and CyberFundamentals evidence factory

Compliance evidence for NIS-2 and the CCB's CyberFundamentals, collected automatically.

- Pulls configuration and control data from dozens of operational systems through their APIs and turns it into audit-ready reporting.
- **Weeks of manual work before every audit** became a repeatable run.
- I handled the source research, defined the data model, and did most of the engineering and the testing myself, all with the help of AI agents.

**Technology:** Python, SQLite, Google Cloud Run

## Sharing knowledge

2018 – 2026

Teaching, presenting and helping others get started.

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| Oct 2026 | **Je hebt 2 jaar: AI for knowledge workers**<br>One-day hands-on training I designed and gave. Participants built their own working AI operating system around one recurring task, from context engineering to automation. On 23 October 2026. |
| Sep 2026 | **AI Team Day: GitHub Copilot Enterprise for team leads**<br>Smals · One-day hands-on training for the team leads of the Infrastructure Fabric & Operations Services division. I designed it and gave it together with a colleague. Every team lead built their own AI workspace around a recurring task of their choice. On 4 September 2026. |
| 2023 – 2026 | **Info sessions on public cloud and security**<br>Smals · For the member institutions of social security and the federal government, often to large audiences. |
| 2018 – 2021 | **IT reporting for franchisees**<br>Burger Brands Belgium · Regular presentations of IT achievements and the related costs at franchisee board meetings and regional meetings. |

## Expertise

What I know and use, grouped by domain.

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| **Leadership and programs** | Program and portfolio management · steering committees and reporting to C-level executives · budgets, CAPEX and OPEX · FinOps · suppliers and public tenders · teams of up to 25 people · interim IT management |
| **Security and compliance** | ISO 27001/27002 · ISAE 3402 · NIS-2 · CCB CyberFundamentals · NIST CSF · C2M2 · OWASP SAMM and ASVS · COBIT · GDPR · post-quantum cryptography |
| **Cloud and infrastructure** | Azure · AWS · Google Cloud · landing zones · Entra ID · VMware · Citrix · Red Hat OpenShift · Windows Server and Active Directory · SAN and NAS |
| **AI and automation** | AI agents and agentic workflows · Claude Code · Codex · Claude Team · ChatGPT Business · LLM pilots · context engineering · Python · automated compliance evidence |

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| **Methods** | PRINCE2 · ITIL v3 · DEMO · Scrum · PMBOK · BPMN · Cloud Adoption Framework |
| **Tools** | Jira · Confluence · Sciforma · ServiceNow · CA Clarity · HP PPM · Power BI · M365 |

## Languages

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| **Dutch** | Native. |
| **French** | Bilingual. Four years of study in France (Angers and Paris) and the Diplôme Supérieur de Français des Affaires. |
| **English** | Full professional proficiency. Studied in Leeds and the daily working language in international programs. |

## Personality

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| **Mar 2019** | **Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI): ISFJ**<br>MBTI profile, European edition (OPP) · Taken on 20 March 2019.<br>ISFJ stands for Introversion, Sensing, Feeling and Judging. In plain words, I prefer quiet focus and start from concrete facts. I keep an eye on the people who will work with the result. And I like a plan and commitments that are kept. |

References and recommendations available on request.